

The Boston Globe

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MONDAY, JULY 28, 2025

Ax falls hardest on colleges' support staff

Project managers, event planners swept up in avalanche of financial setbacks

By Diti Kohli
GLOBE STAFF

The Worcester Polytechnic Institute was the sun around which Bill Battelle's life orbited for almost 30 years.

In the 1990s, he took a job as a catering director at WPI, then switched to lead the school's event planning division in 2013. For decades, Battelle said, he went "way above" his job description, booking meeting rooms and coordinating commencement, while working on WPI's first-ever staff council and assisting with diversity initiatives after hours. He met his wife at WPI, and

they used their steady university paychecks to buy a house in Leicester and raise three daughters.

Then in May, WPI laid Battelle off alongside two dozen other employees, citing rising costs and economic uncertainty.

"I got a chance to have a decent life and work through a lot of different challenges that WPI supported," Battelle said. "All of my involvement with the best interest in the WPI community as a whole, you would feel like it would be enough to sustain your worth" to the school.

Project managers, marketing
HIGHER EDUCATION, Page A10



ERIN CLARK/GLOBE STAFF

Bill Battelle was laid off by Worcester Polytechnic Institute in May. He had served as a catering director and events planner for decades.

US, EU forge deal on trade, tariffs

Many details remain to be hammered out

By Ana Swanson, Jeanna Smialek, and Melissa Eddy
NEW YORK TIMES

The European Union and the United States agreed Sunday to a broad-brush trade deal that sets a 15 percent tariff on most EU goods, including cars, averting what could have become a painful trade war with a bloc that is the United States' single-biggest source of imports.

President Trump said that the European Union had agreed to purchase \$750 billion of American energy, which Ursula von der Leyen, the president of the EU's executive branch, told reporters would be spread out over three years.

The 27-nation bloc also agreed to increase its investment in the United States by more than \$600 billion above current levels, Trump said, adding that the European Union would buy military equipment.

The two sides also agreed to drop tariffs to zero on a range of goods, including aircraft, plane parts, certain chemicals, certain generic drugs, semiconductor equipment, and some agricultural products, von der Leyen said.

Altogether, while it was clear that major details still needed to be hammered out, the framework seemed likely to permanently reshape the trading relationship between two of the world's largest and most interconnected economies.

TARIFFS, Page A6



ERIN CLARK/GLOBE STAFF

From left, firefighters Lieutenant Maison Evangelista, Nathaniel Anderson, and Jose Fletcher discussed the response to the July 13 fire at Gabriel House assisted-living facility in Fall River.

'No words for what I've seen'

For firefighters, Gabriel inferno demanded one furious rescue after another



JESSICA RINALDI/GLOBE STAFF

A woman knelt before a memorial to the 10 people who died in the Gabriel House fire.

By Brian MacQuarrie
GLOBE STAFF

FALL RIVER — Roaring flames and blinding smoke. Screams for help from dozens of windows. Shouted commands and split-second decisions. Scaling tall ladders, panting and exhausted, for rescue after rescue of frightened and disoriented victims.

For a somber group of Fall River firefighters, speaking publicly for the first time since 10 people died at an assisted-living facility here, the night of July 13 was one of teamwork, relentless courage, and horror.

"There are no words for what I've seen," said Lieutenant Maison Evangelista. "Usually, you can let it go, but this one won't go away."

The Fall River fire, the deadliest in the state in 41 years, shocked people in the community and across Massachusetts. In addition to the 10 victims who perished, dozens of residents suffered physical injuries and psychological trauma.

Many of the survivors, some of whom have severe medical needs and are on Medicaid, are scattered in assisted-living facilities.

FIREFIGHTERS, Page A10

By Kay Lazar
GLOBE STAFF

Robert F. Kennedy Jr., the nation's health secretary, sparked fierce criticism earlier this year when he pledged to determine what causes autism by September — a deadline deemed wildly unrealistic by many longtime researchers. Now the Trump administration has followed up with an unusual \$50 million initiative expected to award research grants this month to explore genetic and other factors, such as pregnancy complications, that may contribute to autism.

The projects must conclude within two to three years — a remarkable fast-tracking of science.

The initiative is spawning guarded optimism from researchers who say they're wary of political interference from Kennedy in the scientific process, because he's been a longtime vaccine critic who has for years pushed the debunked claim that routine childhood vaccines cause autism.

But researchers are hopeful that such a financial windfall may generate insights into the causes of autism.

AUTISM INITIATIVE, Page A7

In Roswell, it's not Epstein, it's UFO files

Years after 'incident,' mystery lingers despite Trump's vow to reveal details

By James Pindell
GLOBE STAFF

ROSWELL, N.M. — President Trump made public a trove of once-secret files related to the John F. Kennedy assassination in March and did the same for Martin Luther King Jr. on July 21, as he said he would during the 2024 campaign.

His failure, however, to fulfill another campaign promise — the release of files related to the death of financier and convicted child molester Jeffrey Epstein — has rocked Trump's presidency for the past few weeks.

But here in Roswell, ground zero for the modern era of conspiracy theories, residents and tourists are focused on a different Trump pledge that's seemingly been forgotten: releasing more secret information about what the government knows about UFOs. That includes long-rumored files about the 1947 incident here, when a rancher discovered debris from a large saucer-like disc that the government later hauled away before pretending it never happened and changing the story again and again.

ROSWELL, Page A7



PATRICK T. FALLON/AFP VIA GETTY IMAGES

Tourists perused the Roswell UFO Spacewalk. The city in New Mexico has had an international mystique since 1947.



Preheat; oven

Monday: Mostly sunny.
High 82-87, low 70-75.

Tuesday: Broiling sun returns.
High 92-97, low 71-76.

Sunrise: 5:33. Sunset: 8:08.

Weather and comics, **D4-5**.

Obituaries, **C9**.

VOL. 308, NO. 28

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Suggested retail price
\$4.00

Israel paused attacks in parts of the Gaza Strip in order to facilitate more food aid to desperate civilians. **A4**.

Educators across New England expressed relief after the Trump administration announced it would release billions in funding for teacher training, summer programs, and afterschool activities. **B1**.

A life sciences company is preparing plans to build a massive mixed-use complex that would include 2,000 units of housing near the Alewife MBTA Station in Cambridge. **D1**.

The Red Sox take two out of three from the mighty Dodgers. **C1**.

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